The Family Phone Agreement

The first phone is a big moment.
Let's do it well.



Not a list of rules handed down. A deal your family writes together, signs together, and grows together as trust grows.

The conversation **The agreement** **The pathway**

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FIVE MINUTES BEFORE THE BIG MOMENT

Why a ceremony beats a lecture

The night your child gets their first phone, they will remember how it felt. Make it feel like joining something, not signing surrender papers. So you sit at the table, you talk it through, and you both put your names on a deal you built together. A lecture is over in a minute. A deal you both signed is still on the fridge next term.

THEIR PEN, NOT YOURS

The child writes their own promises in their own handwriting. A rule done to a child gets tested. A promise written by a child gets defended, by them, because it is theirs. Your job is to ask good questions and hold the pen for your half only.

THE DEAL GROWS

This is not a fixed fence. It is a pathway. Every school term you review the deal together, and where trust has grown, the deal loosens. Your child can see the next step on page six, which means they are working towards something, not pushing against you.

THE GOLDEN RULE

This agreement binds both sides. You sign promises too: to knock before you look, to change the deal together rather than by ambush, to answer any question without anger. A deal that only binds the child is not a deal. It is a trap with a signature line, and children can smell the difference instantly.

HOW TO RUN THE EVENING

1. Talk through page three together before the phone comes out of the box. Questions first, phone second.
2. Fill in the agreement side by side. They write their promises, you read yours out loud.
3. Sign, date, and mark the first review date on the calendar there and then.
4. Hand over the phone. Take a photo of the signed page. That photo is the family's receipt.

Print the whole pack on A4. The agreement spread looks its best on slightly heavier paper, and it belongs on the fridge or the pinboard, not in a drawer.

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BEFORE THE PHONE · TALK FIRST, SIGN SECOND

Five questions to talk through together



There are no wrong answers here. Jot down what you both said, because what you decide tonight becomes the agreement on the next page.

Q1 What is this phone actually for?

Calling home? Music? Messaging friends? Name the top three jobs it does.

Q2 Who pays for what?

The phone, the monthly plan, a cracked screen, extras inside apps. Decide now, laugh about it now, not mid argument later.

Q3 What happens at bedtime?

Where does the phone sleep, and when does it go there? Hint: phones sleep better outside bedrooms, and so do their owners.

Q4 What would you do if a stranger messaged you?

Let your child answer first. Then build the plan together. Page seven turns this one into three steps worth keeping.

Q5 What happens when we get it wrong?

Not if. When. Everyone in this family will fumble this at some point, parents included. Decide how we put it right and move on.

DiGi's tip for parents: for every question, say what YOU find hard about your own phone. Honesty going one way is an interview. Honesty going both ways is a family.

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